



Smartphone cameras in 2024 are a whole different beast compared to just a few years ago. As someone who's spent hours testing and comparing them, it's clear the focus isn't just on megapixels anymore; it's about making every shot count. ISPs and algorithms quietly work behind the scenes to make our photos look effortless, even when the lighting isn't cooperating. On the video side, Android phones are really upping their game. Google's Video Boost and Vivo's video chops are closing the gap with the iPhone's long-reigning reliability. A good camera phone now? It's about hardware, software, and how well they click together. Let's see which camera phone wins the Digit Zero1 Award in this cutthroat category.

Winner and Best Buy: Vivo X100 Pro

The Vivo X100 Pro raises the bar for smartphone photography in 2024, staking its claim as the best camera phone of the year. This periscope is a game changer, offering 4.5 stops of optical stabilization and the ability to focus as close as 18 cm, unmatched versatility in the smartphone world. The main camera, featuring Sony's IMX 989 1-inch sensor, produces stunning 125MP images with vibrant colours and lifelike details, even in challenging low-light conditions. The ultrawide camera isn't just an afterthought; it includes autofocus for macro photography and delivers sharp, distortion-free shots. For video enthusiasts, the X100 Pro shines with features like stabilised 8K recording and Vivo's industry-leading colour science, rivaling even the iPhone's dominance in video reliability. It also excels in computational photography, with AI-driven

algorithms that consistently enhance photos and videos. Whether it's dynamic landscapes or intricate close-ups, the Vivo X100 Pro delivers unparalleled results. From ultra-detailed telephoto shots to dynamic macro close-ups, the Vivo X100 Pro doesn't just capture moments; it elevates them. If photography or videography matters to you, this phone is a no-brainer.

Runner-Up: Samsung Galaxy S24 Ultra

The Samsung Galaxy S24 Ultra earns its spot. While its camera setup isn't a radical departure from its predecessor, the inclusion of a 5x telephoto lens offers a fresh balance between mid-range and long-range zoom capabilities. This new telephoto setup delivers sharp 5x zoom shots while maintaining solid hybrid performance at 10x, catering to photographers looking for flexibility without compromising quality. The 200MP primary sensor continues to produce detailed and vibrant 12MP photos through advanced pixel binning. It excels in daylight, capturing a wide dynamic range and natural colours. The ultrawide camera, though not class-leading in sensor size, retains its standout autofocus feature, making it ideal for close-up shots and versatile wide-angle captures. Low-light performance is another strength, with the main and 5x cameras delivering detailed and balanced exposures in challenging conditions. The ultrawide and telephoto lenses provide usable results for most scenarios. Video performance is reliable as well, producing sharp, steady footage with natural colours, making it suitable for casual creators and enthusiasts alike.



Samsung Galaxy S24 Ultra
Price: ₹1,29,999



Google Pixel 9 Pro XL
Price: ₹1,24,999

2nd Runner-Up: Google Pixel 9 Pro XL

The Google Pixel 9 Pro XL boasts a formidable camera system which delivers exceptional image quality, true-to-life colours, and impressive low-light performance. Google's computational photography and AI-driven features, such as Magic Editor and Best Take, further enhance the shooting experience, making it one of the top contenders in smartphone photography. However, the Samsung Galaxy S24 Ultra slightly edges out the Pixel 9 Pro XL in certain aspects. Its 200MP main sensor captures higher-resolution images, providing more detail and flexibility for cropping. Additionally, the S24 Ultra's superior zoom capabilities offer greater versatility for distant subjects. So, the Pixel 9 Pro XL nabs the 2nd runner up spot falling only slightly behind the Galaxy S24 Ultra.

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Camera Smartphone

Opulent optics



Vivo X100 Pro
Price: ₹89,999